Visitor Check-in & Check-out

Developer implementation guide | 12 October 2026

Purpose
Add a complete visiting-child workflow to the Kids Church staff app. Volunteers register a family, assign children to classes, check them in, issue a pickup pass and verify collection.

Preserve the existing app
Keep the current staff dashboard, its existing favourites, greeting, church selection and bottom navigation. Add Visitor Check-in beside Documents in the vacant third-row position. Keep the existing check-in code generation and verification logic; K7P4 in the mockup is illustrative, not a required code format.

Scope
This guide covers the staff journey shown in the eight-screen mockup. Parent self-registration, automated welcome messages and conversion to regular membership are optional later enhancements, not requirements for the first release.

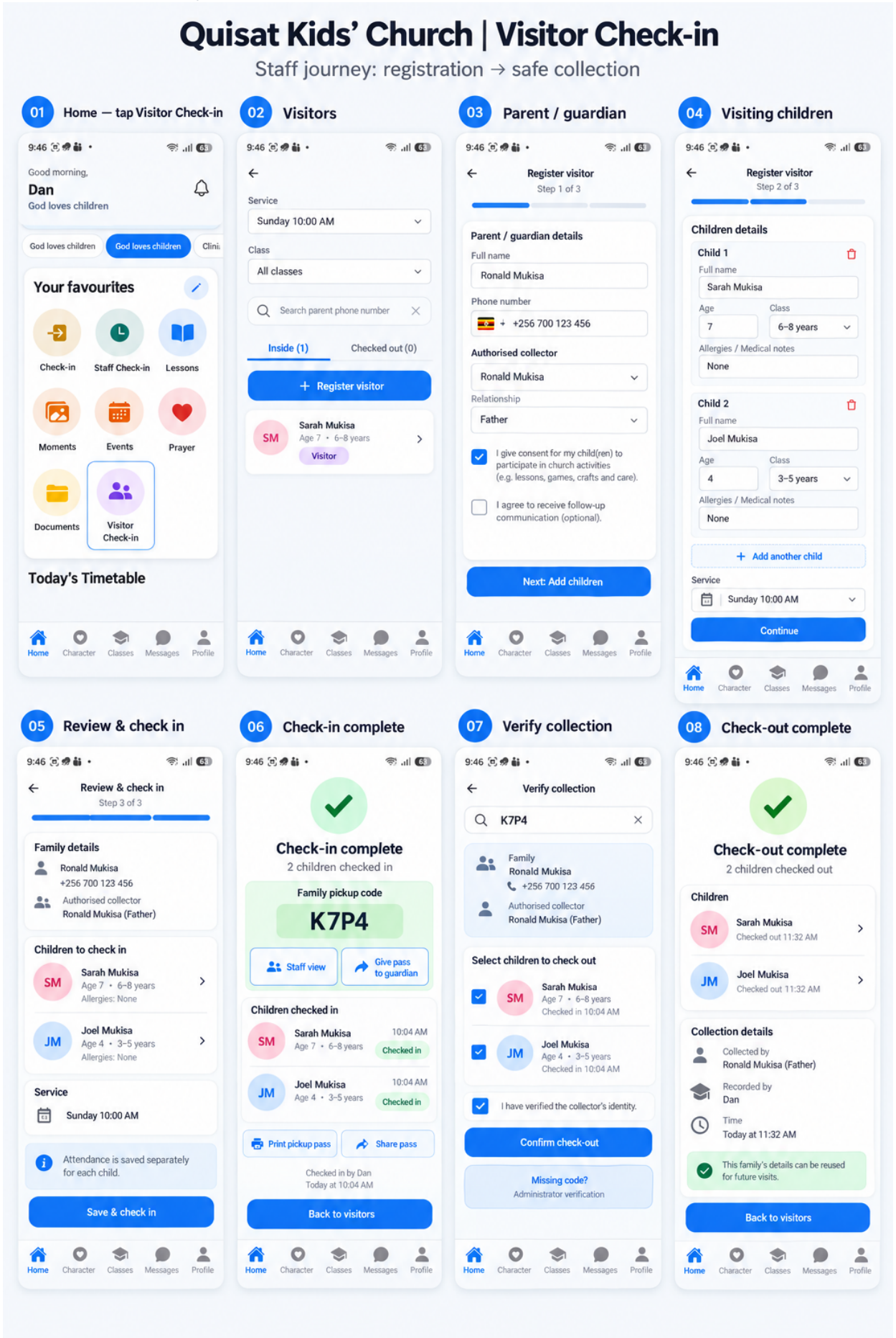
Journey
1. Home 2. Visitor list 3. Guardian details 4. Children
5. Review 6. Pickup pass 7. Verify collection 8. Completion

Design interpretation
The mockup is a visual concept. This written specification takes precedence where the illustration omits a state or control. All names, phone numbers, classes, service times and codes shown are sample data. Classes and services must come from the selected church configuration.

Delivery expectation
Implement visitor registration, returning-family lookup, class filtering, separate child attendance, pickup pass delivery, verified check-out and an audit trail. Verify the acceptance checks at the end before release.

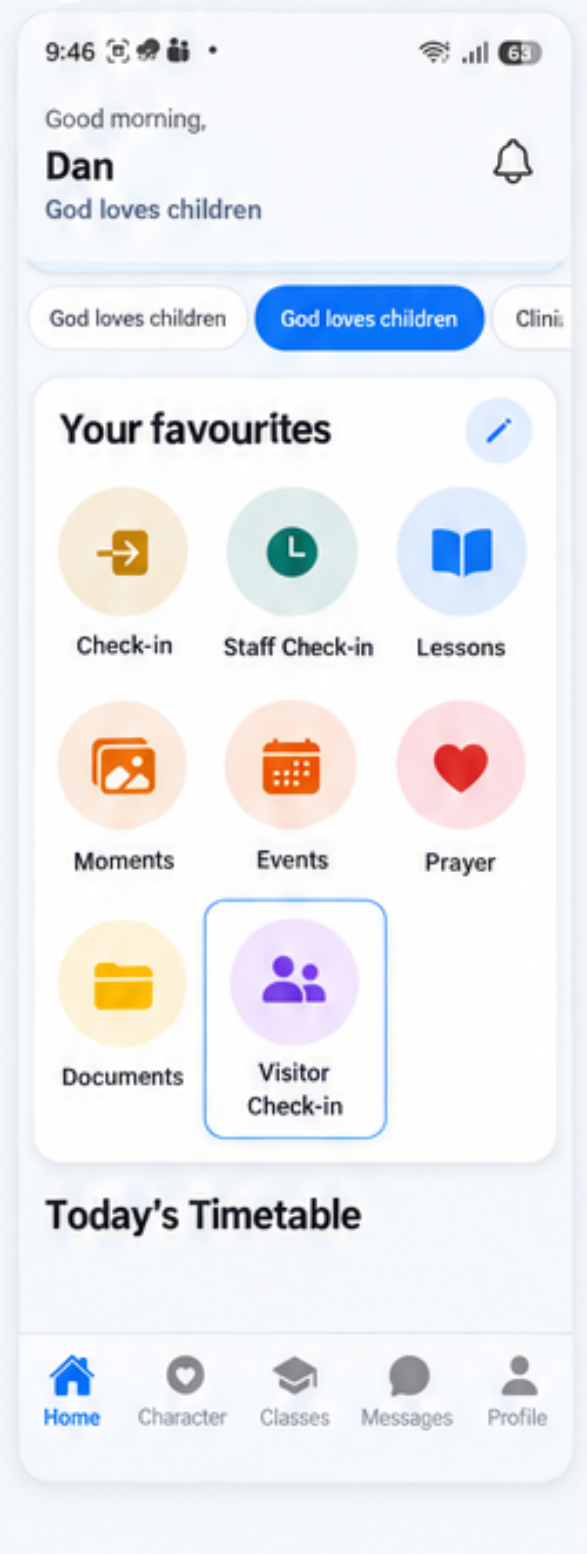
Complete mockup overview

Developer implementation guide | 12 October 2026



01 Home entry point

Developer implementation guide | 12 October 2026



What staff sees

The existing church home screen with a new Visitor Check-in favourite beside Documents.

Action and result

Tap Visitor Check-in to open visitors for the currently selected church. Do not confuse this action with Staff Check-in.

Developer instructions

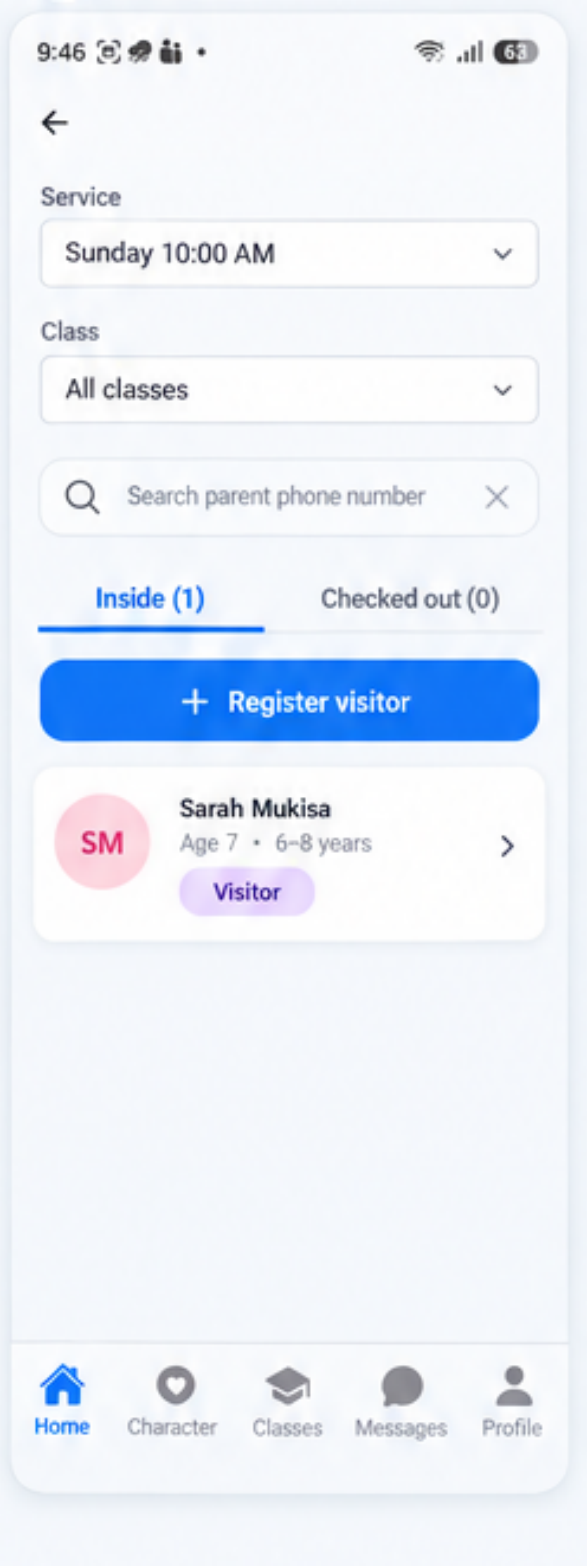
Use the existing favourite component and navigation styling. Preserve all current shortcuts and their order. Show the feature only to authorised church staff; enforce the same access on the server.

Verify

The new shortcut opens the correct church context. Existing child and staff check-in routes continue to work.

02 Visitor register

Developer implementation guide | 12 October 2026



What staff sees

Service and class dropdowns, parent phone search, Inside and Checked out tabs, visitor counts and a Register visitor button.

Action and result

Choose a service, filter by class or search a family. Open a child to inspect the current visit and begin collection. Register visitor starts the form.

Developer instructions

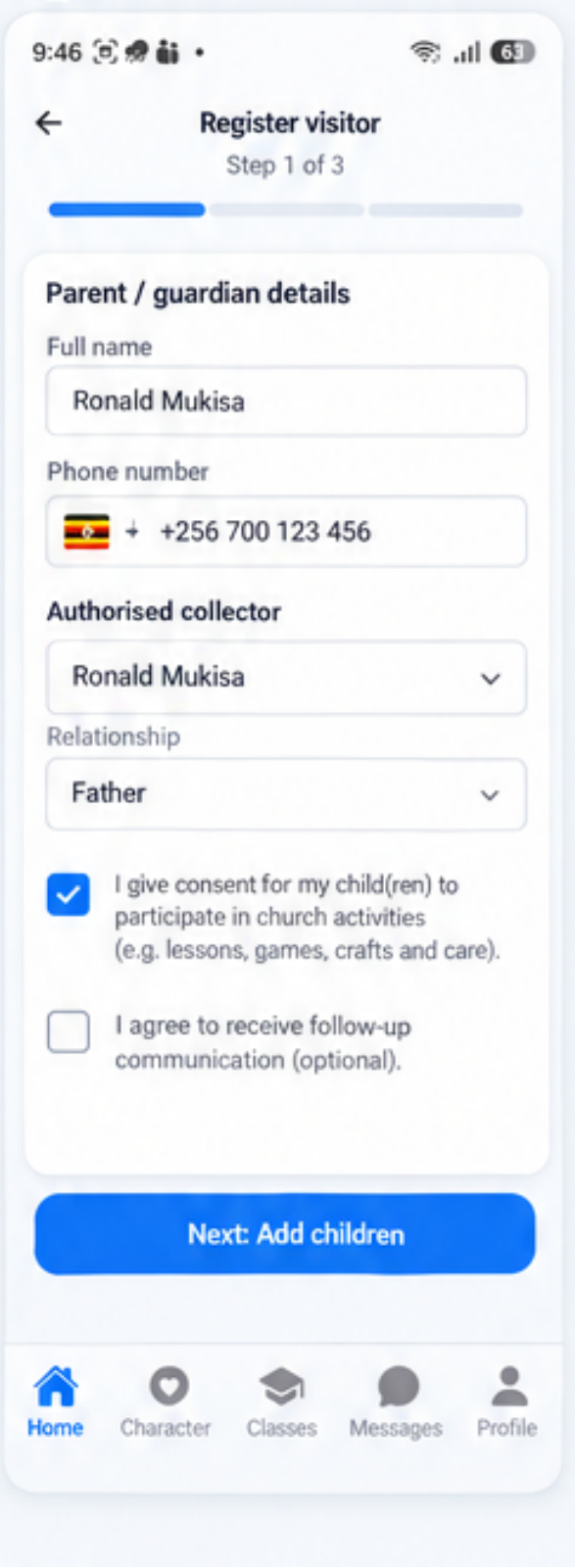
Default to the active service when unambiguous; otherwise require selection. Apply church, service and class filters together. Teachers see assigned classes only; auto-select a sole assigned class. Returning-family lookup must also find previous visitors outside the Inside tab, with a Use existing family action.

States and counts

Counts represent children, not families, and match the applied filters. Provide loading, no visitors, no search match and retry states. Do not expose pickup codes in list cards.

03 Parent / guardian details

Developer implementation guide | 12 October 2026



What staff sees

Guardian name, phone, authorised collector, relationship and two separate consent checkboxes.

Action and result

Enter or confirm family details, then select Next: Add children. For a new family, collector name must allow free text; for existing families, allow selecting or adding a collector.

Developer instructions

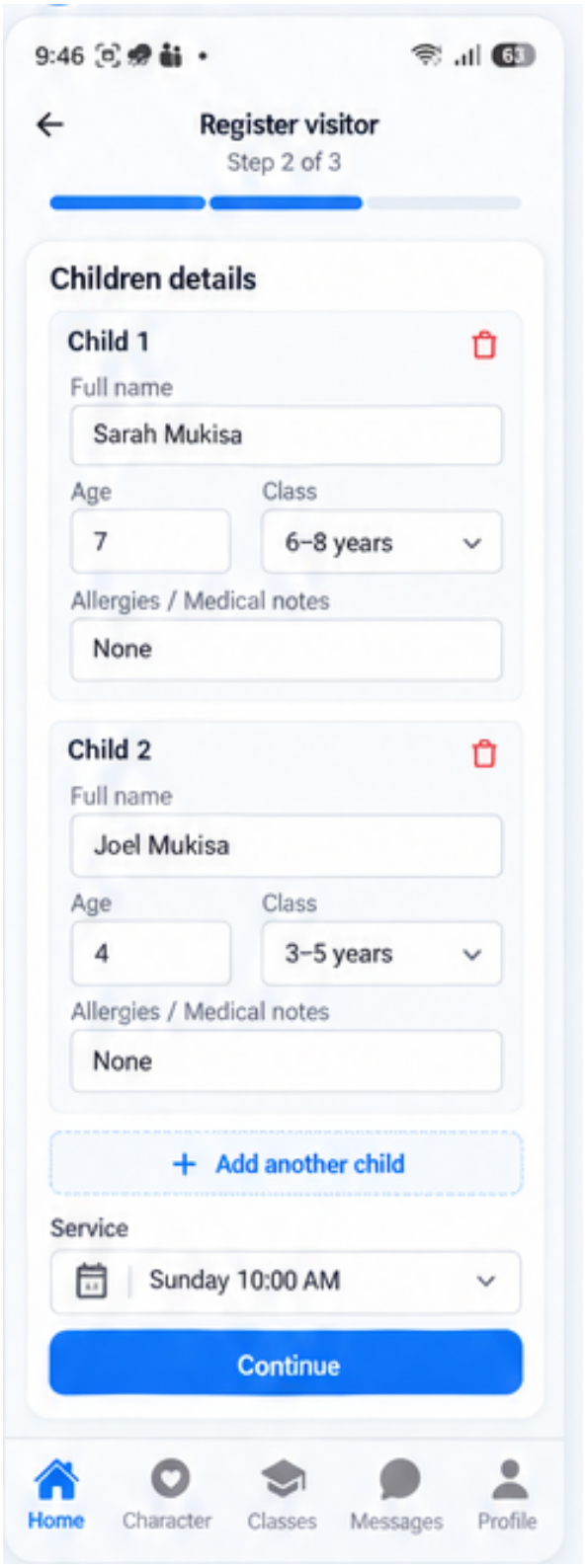
Require guardian name, a valid contact number, collector name and relationship. Support international phone formats with Uganda as a configurable default. Participation consent is required for this workflow; follow-up consent is optional and never preselected. Record consent version, time and staff actor.

Validation

Show errors beside fields and preserve entered values. Phone matches suggest records for staff confirmation; never automatically merge families using a shared phone number.

04 Add visiting children

Developer implementation guide | 12 October 2026



What staff sees

Repeatable child cards containing name, age, class and care notes, plus Add another child and service selection.

Action and result

Add one or several children, assign a class to each and continue. Removing a populated child card requires confirmation.

Developer instructions

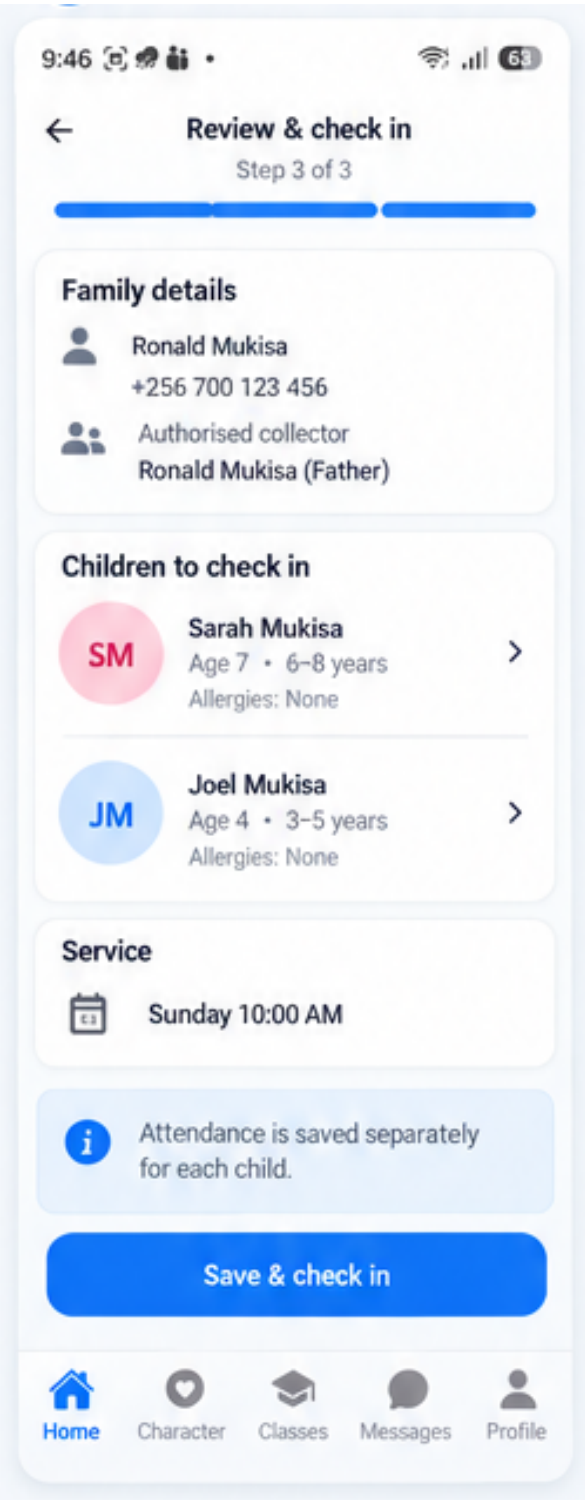
Require at least one child, name, age or date of birth, configured class and service. Prefer date of birth where known; support age when unknown. Recommend age-appropriate classes but allow authorised staff to choose. Save allergies or additional needs as optional restricted care notes.

Validation

Reject invalid ages and missing classes. Warn about possible duplicate children and active visits before saving. Preserve drafts when moving back. Any class-capacity rule must use the church configuration.

05 Review & check in

Developer implementation guide | 12 October 2026



What staff sees

Guardian, collector, selected children, care notes, class and service, followed by Save & check in.

Action and result

Confirm the details or go back to edit. Save creates the family/children where needed and a separate attendance record for every selected child.

Developer instructions

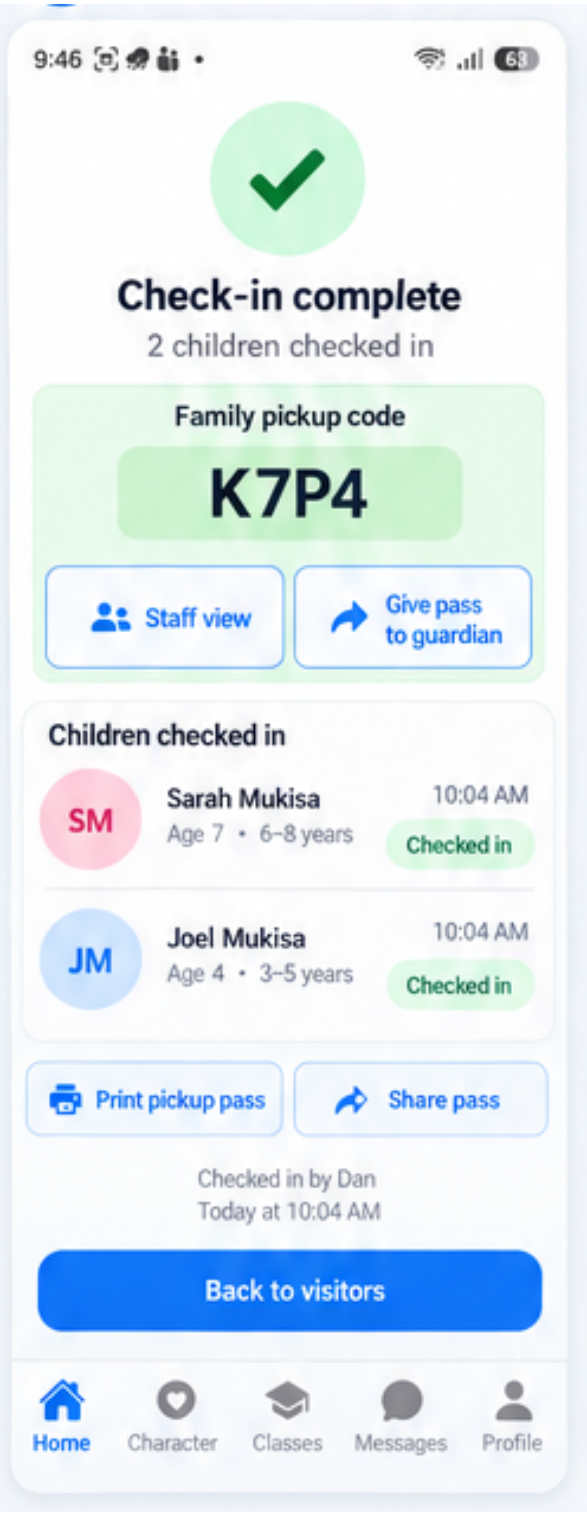
Use server time and record the volunteer. Reuse existing child IDs for returning visitors. Prevent duplicate active attendance for a child/service. Disable repeated taps and use idempotent requests. Commit the selected family check-in together; if saving fails, keep the draft and show retry without a success screen.

Code handling

Reuse the current pickup-code mechanism. The design displays one family pass, but the developer must confirm that current code logic supports family collection. If codes are child-specific, show each child code on the family pass instead of silently changing verification logic.

06 Check-in complete & pass

Developer implementation guide | 12 October 2026



What staff sees

Success status, children checked in, arrival time and the pickup pass. Print and Share pass actions appear below.

Action and result

Give the pass to the guardian. Print generates a readable pass; Share opens an explicit staff-initiated share action. Back to visitors returns to the register.

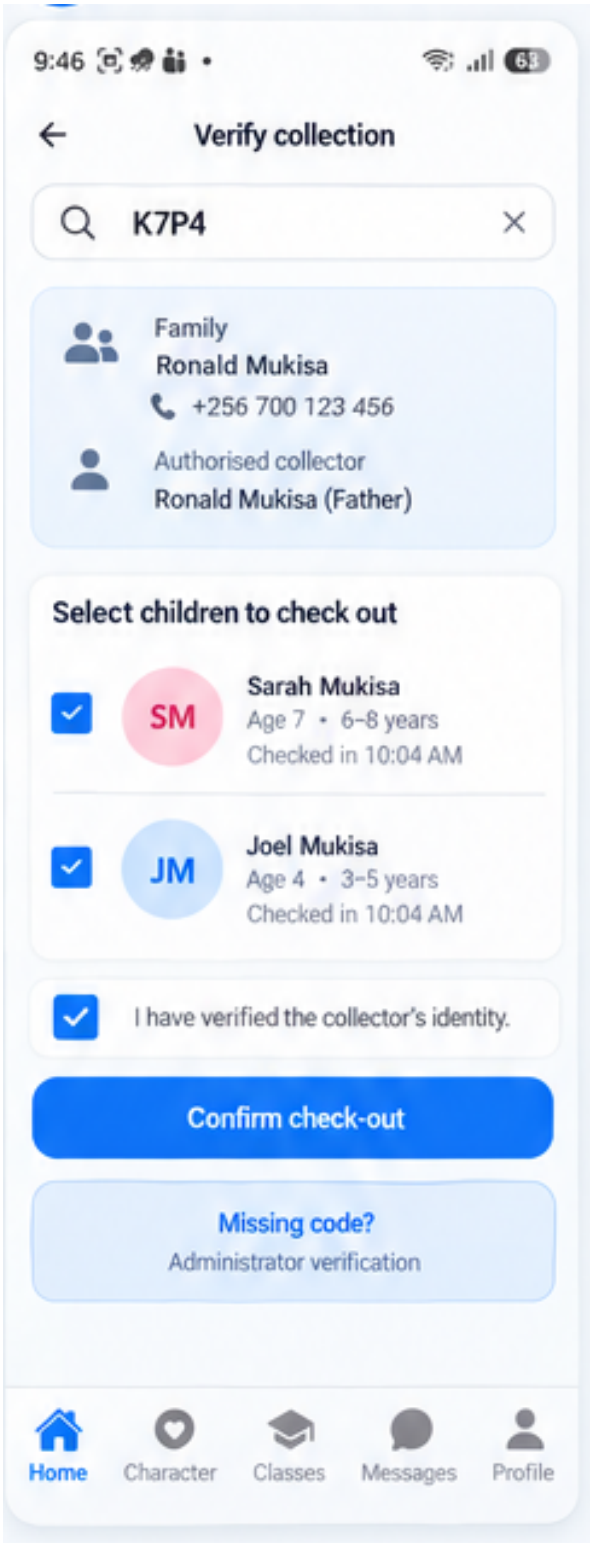
Developer instructions

Show success only after server confirmation. Labels link each child to the appropriate valid code. Include child name, class, service and arrival time on labels; guardian pass must identify the children covered. Do not place sensitive care notes on public labels. Make the Staff view / Give pass to guardian labels clear controls, or remove them if redundant.

Failure handling

If printing or sharing fails, attendance stays checked in. Allow reprint without a second check-in or code regeneration. Follow the existing code lifecycle and limit code access to authorised staff and the guardian.

07 Verify collection



What staff sees

Code entry, family and collector details, selectable checked-in children, identity verification and Confirm check-out.

Action and result

Enter the code using existing verification logic, verify the authorised collector and select only the children being collected. A sibling can remain checked in.

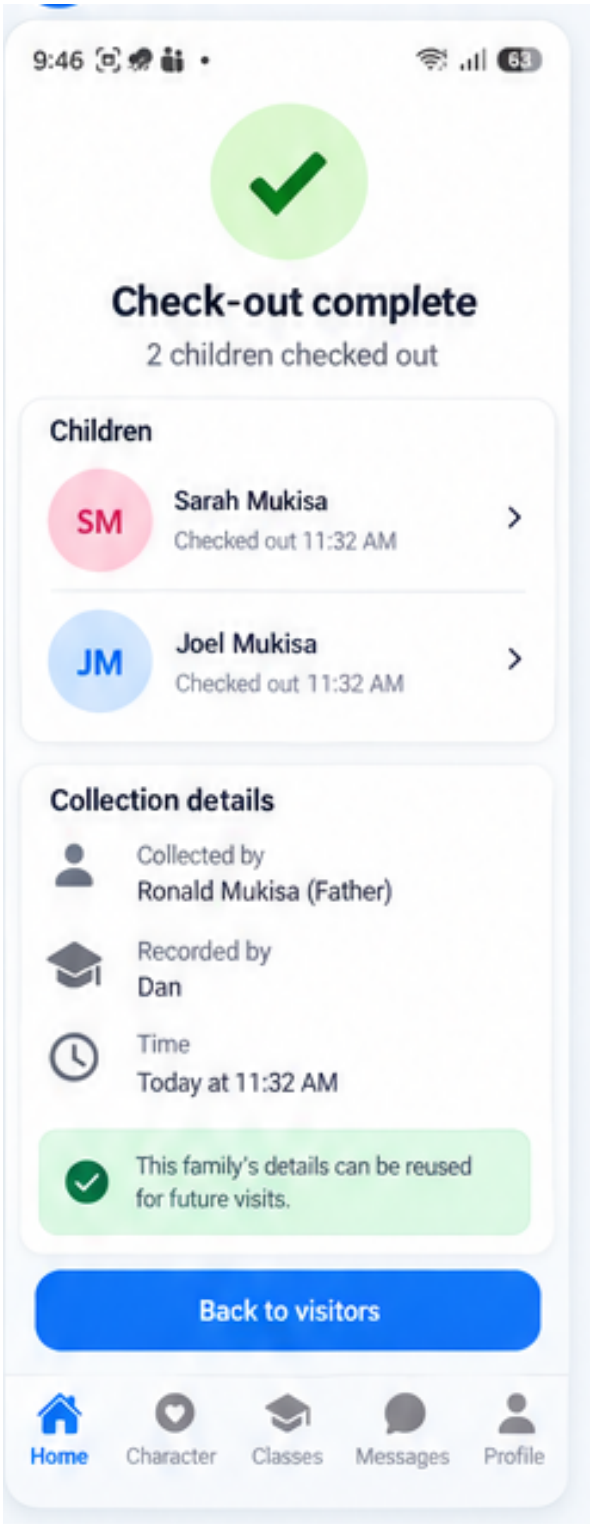
Developer instructions

Require a valid active code, at least one active child and collector verification. Do not release a child solely because a code was entered. Invalid, expired or unrelated codes must block normal checkout. Restrict repeated code attempts and expose only the matching authorised visit.

Missing code exception

Administrator verification opens a separate restricted flow. Record verified collector, verification method, reason, approving administrator and time before allowing collection. Cancel or failed verification leaves the child checked in; do not offer an unlogged bypass.

08 Check-out complete



What staff sees
Only the children actually checked out, departure times, collector and recording volunteer.

Action and result
Return to visitors. Checked-out children move to the Checked out tab; siblings not selected remain in Inside.

Developer instructions
Persist one checkout per selected attendance record with server time, collector and staff ID. Use an idempotent transaction and prevent repeated checkout. Reuse family details for future visits only after staff confirmation; create new service attendance and apply the existing code lifecycle.

Partial collection and errors
If one child was collected, show 1 child checked out and identify any siblings still inside. If saving fails, do not show completion or remove children from Inside. Retrying must not create duplicate records.

Implementation requirements

Developer implementation guide | 12 October 2026

Records and relationships
Store church ID on all visitor records. Keep family/guardian, child and authorised collector records separate from service attendance. Attendance includes child, service, class, visitor status, arrival/departure, staff actors, collector and a reference to the existing pickup credential.

Permissions
Church administrators manage the feature and approve exceptions. Authorised reception volunteers register and process collection. Teachers view permitted class attendance and relevant care notes only. Enforce permissions and church boundaries on every API, export, code lookup and pass request.

Audit and edits
Log registration, check-in, check-out, collector changes, consent updates and exception approvals with actor and time. Changes to collectors during an active visit need authorised review and an audit entry. Historical corrections must preserve the original action.

Reliability
Validate on client and server. Use server timestamps, display local church time and preserve drafts after errors. Block duplicate active check-ins. Do not report completed check-in or collection while offline unless an existing approved offline attendance mechanism safely supports it.

Care information and communication
Limit care-note access to people responsible for the child. Separate participation from follow-up consent. Sharing a pass is a deliberate user action; do not automatically send follow-up messages. Provide live Inside records for an authorised emergency headcount.

Extend existing logic
Reuse the current attendance and pickup code services where possible. Assess family-code compatibility before implementing the illustrated family pass. Keep current code format, expiry and verification rules. No API endpoints or storage schema are assumed to already exist.

Acceptance checks & handover

Developer implementation guide | 12 October 2026

01 Dashboard and access
Only Visitor Check-in is added. Existing favourites and navigation work. Unauthorised users and users from another church cannot access visitor records or pickup passes.

02 Registration
Register two siblings in different classes. Required fields block submission when missing. Follow-up consent remains optional. Going back retains entered data. Returning-family lookup reuses confirmed records without merging unrelated families.

03 Check-in
Save creates two separate attendance records. Repeated taps or request retries do not duplicate them. Success appears only after persistence. Class and service filters show the correct children and counts.

04 Pass and collection
Print/reprint does not check in again. A wrong code blocks checkout. A valid code still requires authorised collector verification. Checkout of one sibling leaves the other inside. Already checked-out children cannot be checked out again.

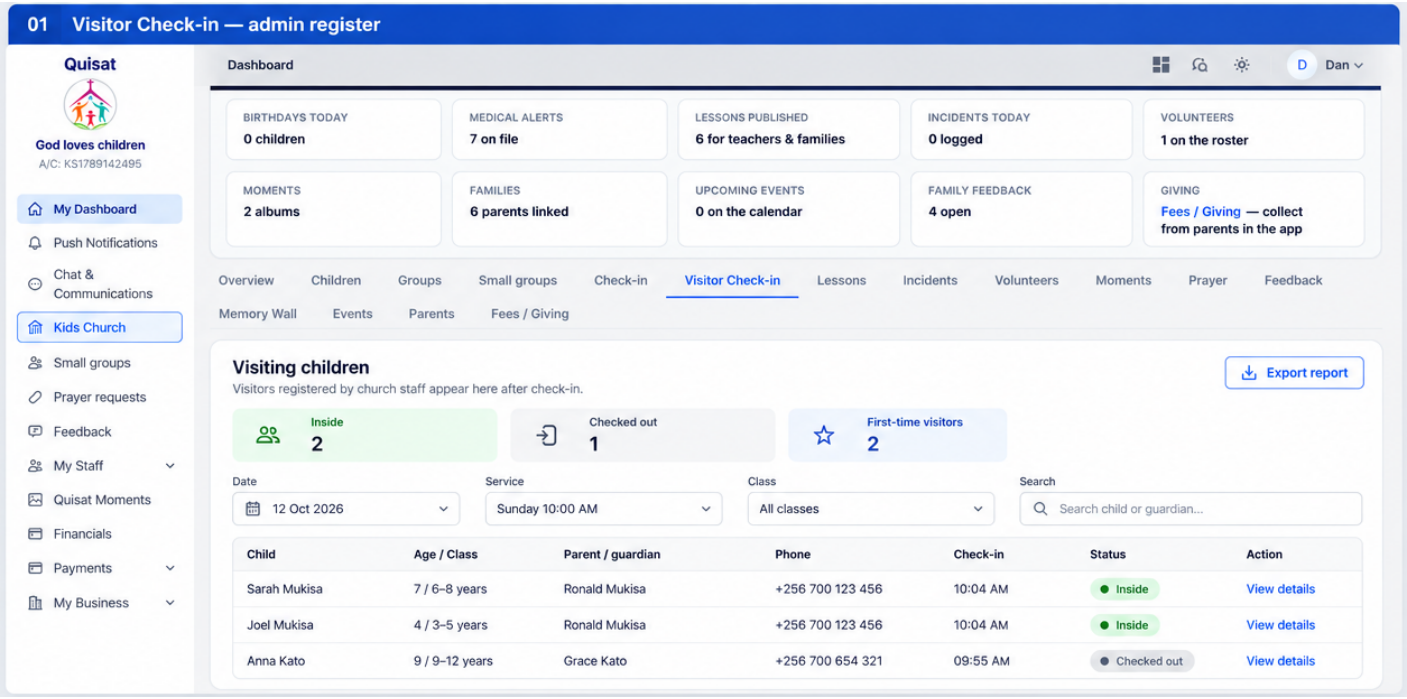
05 Exception and failure
A missing code requires administrator verification and an audit record. Cancelling leaves attendance unchanged. Network/save failure does not show false success; safe retry preserves accurate attendance.

06 Reporting and existing behaviour
Checked-out records show collector, departure and recording staff. The Inside list provides a correct headcount. Existing member-child and staff check-in code workflows pass regression checks.

Developer handover
Deliver implemented screens, permission configuration, data migration if required, pass rendering and a short test record covering the checks above. Confirm family-code compatibility and the church service/class configuration before development. Optional future work: parent self-registration, consented follow-up and conversion to regular membership with history preserved.

Admin: visitor register

Developer implementation guide | 12 October 2026



Navigation

Add Visitor Check-in immediately after Check-in and before Lessons within Kids Church. Preserve the existing dashboard cards, sidebar and other navigation items. The new tab opens the visitor register.

Staff-to-admin visibility

After a staff check-in saves successfully, show each visiting child in the admin register without a second registration. Use the same church-scoped child, family and attendance records. Refresh the list on entry and after changes; provide a manual refresh if live updates are unavailable.

Register controls

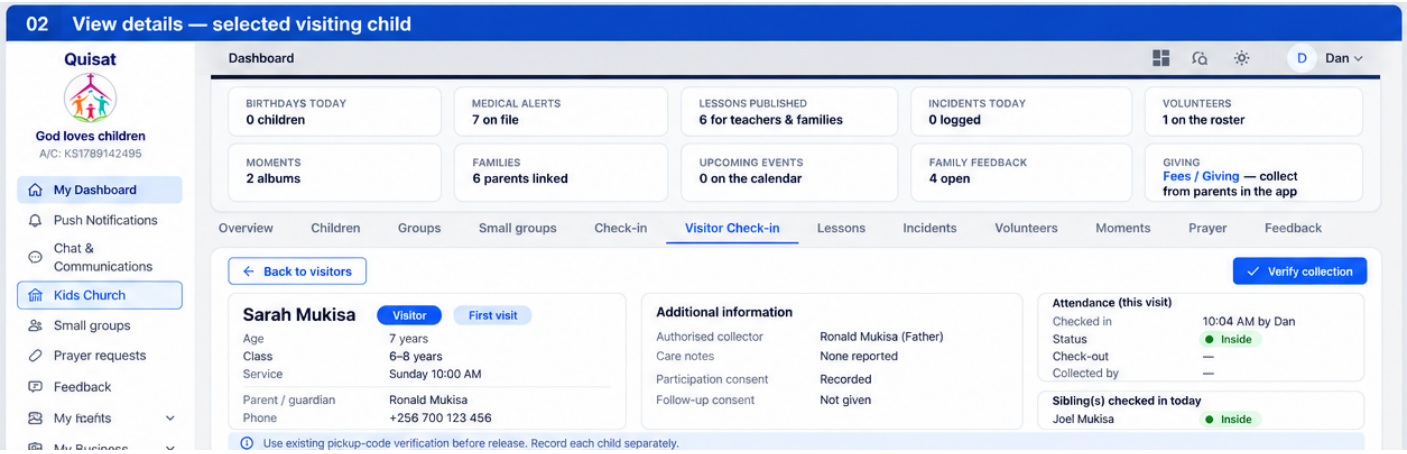
Filter by date, service and class, and search child or guardian name or phone. Show child, age/class, guardian, phone, check-in time, current status and View details. Counts reflect children within the selected filters. First-time means the child has no earlier recorded visit to this church.

Reports and access

Inside includes only active attendance; Checked out includes completed attendance. Export the currently filtered register only for permitted administrators. Keep pickup codes out of the register. Provide empty, loading and retry states.

Admin: visiting child details

Developer implementation guide | 12 October 2026



Open a record

View details opens the selected child and visit. Display visitor/first-visit status, age, assigned class, service, guardian name and phone, authorised collector, care notes and the recorded consent choices.

Attendance and siblings

Show check-in time and staff actor, current status, checkout time, collector and checkout staff actor when available. Display siblings linked to the family for the selected service and their individual statuses. Do not infer that all siblings have left when one is collected.

Collection action

Verify collection opens the existing pickup verification flow described in screen 07. Apply the same authorised collector and missing-code administrator checks. Showing details or pressing the button must not itself release a child. Hide the action for completed visits or users without collection permission.

Mockup interpretation

The admin illustration is a concept. The written requirements include all details even when a field is omitted in the image. Keep all existing secondary navigation tabs available; allow wrapping as needed. Restrict care information and visitor contacts to authorised church users.

Admin integration: acceptance checks

Developer implementation guide | 12 October 2026

01 Placement and existing dashboard
Visitor Check-in appears immediately after Check-in. Existing dashboard summaries, sidebar, member check-in and staff functions continue to work. The active tab uses existing blue styling.

02 Shared records
Check in a two-child visitor family from the staff app. Both children appear once in the admin register with the correct guardian, service, class and time. Refreshing does not duplicate records. The admin never needs to register the same family again.

03 Filters and details
Date/service/class filters and search produce matching rows and counts. View details opens the correct child and visit, including care notes, collector and consent status. Confirm returning visitors retain history and are not incorrectly labelled first-time.

04 Collection synchronisation
Collect only one sibling using verified pickup. The admin shows that child as checked out with collector and staff actor, while the other remains inside. Staff and admin show consistent states after refresh. Invalid code and failed verification block collection.

05 Permissions and reporting
Unauthorised users cannot view visitor contacts, care notes, codes or exports. Another church cannot retrieve records by changing an ID. Export contains only the selected authorised records. No pickup code appears in the general register.

06 Error handling
Loading and empty states are clear. A failed staff save creates no false admin attendance. A failed admin fetch offers retry. Concurrent staff/admin checkout attempts result in only one saved checkout.

Implementation boundary
This admin section extends the staff specification in pages 1-12. Both interfaces share the same underlying visitor and attendance services. Preserve the existing pickup-code rules, including the family-code compatibility check described earlier.